

MARCO A. BADILLA MAROTO

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

Ph.D. in Economics, Field: Labor Economics

Expected May 2027

University of Costa Rica

B.A. in Economics (with honors, Class rank: first)

Fall 2020

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

NERA Economic Consulting, Ph.D. Intern

Summer 2026

Conducted economic analysis for an antitrust litigation matter in the pharmaceutical industry.

Guided analysts in conducting empirical analyses.

Central Bank of Costa Rica, Intern

Spring 2019

Developed dynamic forecasting models for several price indices.

Analyzed the evolution of wage inequality in Costa Rica.

RESEARCH

Disrupting Education's Old Guard: The Labor Market Effects of Replacing Traditional In-Class Exams with Group Projects, with Alonso Alfaro-Ureña (Central Bank of Costa Rica)

Skill Measurement, Returns and Mismatch: Evidence from Narrative Evaluations

Senior Migration, Local Economic Development and Spatial Inequality, with Benjamin Faber (UC Berkeley), Antoine Levy (UC Berkeley), and Mathilde Muñoz (UC Berkeley)

Talent Heterogeneity and Misallocation, with Alonso Alfaro-Ureña (Central Bank of Costa Rica)

PUBLISHED WORK

Alfaro, A., Badilla, M.A., Manelici, I., and Vásquez, J. (2021). **Importancia relativa de los beneficios intangibles de la Inversión Extranjera Directa (IED) en Zonas Francas en Costa Rica**. Research Paper DI-08-2021, Research Department, Central Bank of Costa Rica.

Badilla, M.A. (2020). **The Role of the Gender Wage Gap in Overall Wage Inequality: A Quantitative Exercise**. *Economía*, Latin American and Caribbean Economic Association, 21(1), 169–207.

HONORS & RESEARCH GRANTS

AERA-NSF Dissertation Grant, American Educational Research Association and National Science Foundation (2026)

Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award, Department of Economics, UC Berkeley (2026)

IRLE Graduate Student Research Award, Institute for Research on Labor and Employment, UC Berkeley (2025)

CLACS Tinker Field Grant, Center for Latin American and Caribbean Studies, UC Berkeley (2024)

Highest Annual GPA, School of Economics, University of Costa Rica (2016–2018)

Top 5 National Admission Scores, University of Costa Rica (2015): 795.55/800

CONFERENCES

Gardner Seminar Series, UC Berkeley Center for Studies in Higher Education (2025–2026)

All California Labor Conference, Poster Session (2025)

All Costa Rica Economics Conference (2022)

TEACHING

Econometrics (Lead Teaching Assistant)

2023–2026

Led and coordinated a team of 10 graduate teaching assistants.

Macroeconomic Policy (Teaching Assistant)

Fall 2022

SKILLS

Software	Stata, R, LaTeX
Languages	English (fluent), Spanish (native)

REFERENCES

Jesse Rothstein

Professor, UC Berkeley
rothstein@berkeley.edu

Benjamin Faber

Professor, UC Berkeley
benfaber@econ.berkeley.edu

Sydnee Caldwell

Professor, UC Berkeley
scaldwell@berkeley.edu

Christopher Walters

Professor, UC Berkeley
crwalters@econ.berkeley.edu